Adverbs: Quick Tutorial

Learn the basics, study the examples, and complete the practice questions.

What is an adverb?

An **adverb** is a word that describes a **verb**, an **adjective**, or another **adverb**. Adverbs often explain how, when, where, how often, or to what degree something happens.

1. Adverbs describing verbs

These adverbs can tell us how, when, where, or how often an action happens.

> She speaks **softly**. *(How?)*
> We arrived **yesterday**. *(When?)*
> Come **inside**. *(Where?)*
> He **often** cooks. *(How often?)*

2. Adverbs describing adjectives

These adverbs show the degree or intensity of an adjective.

> The test was **very** difficult.
> She is **extremely** patient.

3. Adverbs describing other adverbs

An adverb can also change or strengthen the meaning of another adverb.

> He walks **very** slowly.
> She finished **surprisingly** quickly.

Forming adverbs

Many adverbs are made by adding **-ly** to an adjective: **careful - carefully**, **quiet - quietly**, and **slow - slowly**.

Some adverbs are irregular: **good - well**, **fast - fast**, and **hard - hard**.

A common mistake

> **Hard** and **hardly** have different meanings. *She works hard* means she puts in a lot of effort. *She hardly works* means she does almost no work.

Adverb Practice

Name: _____ Date: _____

Complete all 10 questions. Refer to the tutorial if you need help.

1. The baby slept _____ throughout the night. *(peaceful)*

2. Maria completed the assignment _____. *(quick)*

3. James is a _____ good musician.
   a. very b. careful c. beautifully

4. Identify the adverb or adverbs in this sentence:
   The children happily played outside.

Answer: _____

5. Change the adjective **careful** into an adverb.

Answer: _____

6. She sings _____. *(good)*

7. Which sentence is correct?
   a. He runs fastly.
   b. He runs fast.
   c. He fast runs.

8. The teacher explained the lesson _____, so everyone understood it.
   a. clearly b. clear c. clarity

9. In the sentence *We will leave tomorrow*, what does the adverb **tomorrow** tell us?
   a. How b. When c. Where

10. Explain the difference in meaning between these sentences:
    Liam works hard.
    Liam hardly works.

_____

_____

_____